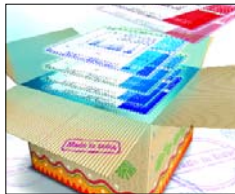




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Digital Business

How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

Case Study

Weapons of Mass Promotion

What does a brand manager do when no one clicks on banner ads any more? Force people to view ads by promising entry into a contest, of course... what's more, the consumer willingly does so!

Ram Mohan Rao

How do you like a pop-up ad being shoved in your face? Or a banner ad that keeps flashing on a Web page as you try to read what you're reading? Of course you don't. Plus, there is a good chance that you already have a pop-up blocker to prevent the annoyance in the first place.

Banner ads, pop-ups and the like were once major revenue generators for Web sites. That is not to say that they are not now, but the scene has changed, and the efficacy of that advertising medium is under question. Seth Godin, former Head of Direct Marketing at Yahoo.com and author of *Permission Marketing*, says: "Marketing by interrupting people isn't cost-effective any more. You can't afford to seek out people and send them unwanted marketing

messages, in large groups, and hope that some will send you money."

Interruptive advertising, then, is on its way out. Banner ads are declining; pops-ups are being removed; spam is being restricted; telemarketing is being controlled; and TV ads are being zapped. That may sound like good news for the rest of us, but for the advertising industry—rather, the interruptive-advertising industry—it's no laughing matter.

The new mantra is interactive marketing, of which Alok Kejriwal, CEO of Contests2win.com (C2W), has been a pioneer in India. C2W, while marketing products, engages the customer in a friendly way; it's a form of opt-in advertising. C2W believes that interactive marketing will soon replace interruptive marketing. In this model, consumers willingly interact with brands by spending their quality time being entertained, having fun, winning,



Imaging Atul Deshmukh, Jayan Narayanan